Name: Student ID:

Is Yawning Contagious?

An experiment conducted by MythBusters tested if a person can be subconsciously influenced into yawning if another person near them yawns.

In this study 50 people were randomly assigned to two groups: 34 to a group where a person near them yawned (`group`: `stimulus`) and 16 to a control group where there wasn't a yawn seed (`group`: `no stimulus`). They then recorded the whether each subject yawned (`response`: `yawn`) or not (`response`: `no yawn`).

```
             no yawn yawn
no stimulus      12    4
stimulus         24   10
```

(1) What is the explanatory variable? Response variable?

(2) What was the proportion of yawners in the stimulus group, $\hat{p}_s$?

(3) What was the proportion of yawners in the no stimulus group, $\hat{p}_n$?

(4) If there were *no association* between yawning and the proximity of another yawner, what would you expect the difference to be between these two proportions?

(5) What are the possible values that $\hat{p}_s - \hat{p}_n$ can take? (i.e., what is the maximum value? the minimum value?)

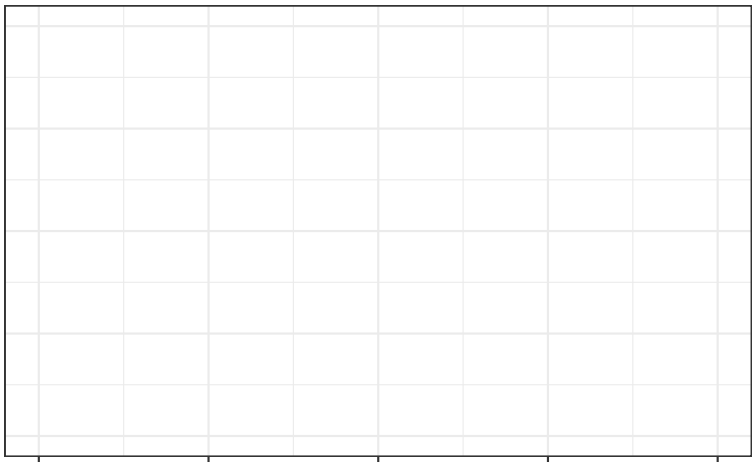
(6) In terms of $\hat{p}_s - \hat{p}_n$, what is an example of a result that would demonstrate a `strong` association between yawning and being exposed to a yawn?

Simulating Yawners

What kind of data would be observed if there was no association between these variables and if the only variation was caused by the process of randomly assigning subjects to the two conditions? Find out by *simulating* the process.

1. Create a deck of cards, 36 of which represent subjects who did not yawn, 14 of which represent subjects who yawned.
2. Shuffle the deck of cards to simulate the process of randomly assignment to the two conditions: being exposed to a yawn (stimulus) and not being exposed (no stimulus).
3. Deal them into two decks of size 16 and 34, representing the 1/3 of the subjects that were assigned to the no stimulus group and the 2/3 assigned to the stimulus group.
4. Calculate the difference in the proportion of yawners in the two group, $\hat{p}_s - \hat{p}_n$, and record it below.
5. Repeat the process 5 more times to create a distribution of 6 simulated statistics. Go to the front of the room and place your statistics on the visualization the instructor has started there. Once the entire class has finished, you will sketch the complete null distribution in the graph provided.

Sim	$\hat{p}_s - \hat{p}_n$
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	



(7) If there was in fact no relationship between yawning and the stimulus, what values of the statistic would you expect to see?

(8) What value of $\hat{p}_s - \hat{p}_n$ did the MythBusters actually observe?

(9) Is this data convincing evidence that yawning is contagious? Why or why not?